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The Development of Dynamic Syntax

Guest Editor Welcome Guide

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Special Issue Information

Dear Colleagues,

We are pleased to announce a call for a special issue of the journal *Languages* (ISSN 2226-471X) on “The Development of Dynamic Syntax”. Dynamic Syntax (DS) is an action-based grammar formalism that models the process of natural language understanding as monotonic tree growth, which was first introduced in response to well-studied grammatical puzzles like scrambling, clitic doubling and person-case restrictions, among others (Kempson et al., 2001; Cann et al., 2005; Chatzikyriakidis and Kempson

as a grammar formalism solving just syntactic puzzles, but also applied to questions around diachronic change, pragmatic problems and interactive issues (Bouzouita 2008, Eshghi et al. 2016, Kempson et al., 2016, amongst others).

The Special Issue is intended to both reflect the broad range of work within the framework of Dynamic Syntax in diverse areas such as the syntax of diverse languages, language change, semantics/pragmatics, and dialogue modelling with a focus on recent directions in Dynamic Syntax research. Ultimately, our aim is to showcase a unified formal framework that can tackle a spectrum of phenomena from narrow syntax/semantics puzzles all the way to dialogue modelling and linguistic interaction.

We request that, prior to submitting a manuscript, interested authors initially submit a proposed title and an abstract of 200 words summarising their intended contribution. Please send it to the Guest Editors christine.howes@gu.se or to *Languages* Editorial Office (languages@mdpi.com). Abstracts will be reviewed by the Guest Editors for the purposes of ensuring proper fit within the scope of the special issue. Full manuscripts will undergo double-blind peer-review.

Tentative Completion Schedule

Abstract Submission Deadline: 8 January 2025
Notification of Abstract Acceptance: 15 January 2025
Full Manuscript Deadline: 20 August 2025

References

Bouzouita, M. (2008). *The diachronic development of Spanish clitic placement* (Doctoral dissertation, King's College London).

Cann, R., Kempson, R., & Marten, L. (2005). The dynamics of language. Oxford: Elsevier.

Chatzikyriakidis, S., & Kempson, R. (2011). Standard Modern and Pontic Greek person restrictions: A feature-free dynamic account. *Journal of Greek Linguistics*, *11*(2), 127-166.

Kempson, R., Meyer-Viol, W., & Gabbay, D. (2001). Dynamic Syntax: The flow of language understanding. Oxford: Blackwell.

Kempson, R., Cann, R., Gregoromichelaki, E., & Chatzikiriakidis, S. (2016). Language as mechanisms for interaction. Theoretical Linguistics, 42(3–4), 203–275.

Eshghi, Arash, Christine Howes, Eleni Gregoromichelaki, Julian Hough, and Matthew Purver. "Feedback in conversation as incremental semantic update". Association for Computational Linguistics, 2015.

Prof. Dr. Christine Howes
Prof. Dr. Stergios Chatzikyriakidis
Guest Editors

Manuscript Submission Information

Manuscripts should be submitted online at www.mdpi.com by registering and logging in to this website. Once you are registered, click here to go to the submission form. Manuscripts can be submitted until the deadline. All submissions that pass pre-check are peer-reviewed. Accepted papers will be published continuously in the journal (as soon as accepted) and will be listed together on the special issue website. Research articles, review articles as well as short communications are invited. For planned papers, a title and short abstract (about 250 words) can be sent to the Editorial Office for assessment.

Submitted manuscripts should not have been published previously, nor be under consideration for publication elsewhere (except conference proceedings papers). All manuscripts are thoroughly refereed through a double-blind peer-review process. A guide for authors and other relevant information for submission of manuscripts is available on the Instructions for Authors page. *Languages* is an international peer-reviewed open access monthly journal published by MDPI.

Please visit the Instructions for Authors page before submitting a manuscript. The Article Processing Charge (APC) for publication in this open access journal is 1600 CHF (Swiss Francs). Submitted papers should be well formatted and use good English. Authors may use MDPI's English editing service prior to publication or during author revisions.

Keywords

dynamic syntax | language change | semantics/pragmatics | dialogue modelling

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Vladislav Maraev, Arash Eshghi, Chiara Mazzocconi and Christine Howes

Languages
2026, *11*(2), 25;
https://doi.org/10.3390/languages11020025
29 January 2026

In dialogue, laughter is a frequent non-verbal signal that can precede, follow, or overlap its antecedent—the laughable. Furthermore, the time alignment between the laughter and the laughable is dependent on who produces the laughable, whether... Show more

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Dynamic Syntax in a Theory of Types with Records

Robin Cooper and Staffan Larsson

Languages
2025, *10*(12), 300;
https://doi.org/10.3390/languages10120300
10 December 2025

This paper presents a recasting of key aspects of dynamic syntax (DS) in a theory of types with records (TTR), concentrating on the incremental processing of speech events as they unfold and viewed in terms of classifying these events in terms of gra... Show more

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Ronnie Cann

Languages
2025, *10*(12), 289;
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Constructive Dynamic Syntax

Stergios Chatzikyriakidis

Languages
2025, *10*(11), 269;
https://doi.org/10.3390/languages10110269
23 October 2025

This paper explores the integration of constructive type theory in the tradition of Martin Löf into Dynamic Syntax.

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Interests: dialogue; interaction; conversational repair; common-sense reasoning

Prof. Dr. Stergios Chatzikyriakidis

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Interests: computational semantics; natural language understanding; formal syntax/semantics; computational dialectology

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